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Galaxy S21 FE 5G

Powerful all-rounder

The Galaxy S20 FE was one of Samsung's better-selling phones of 2020. It brought with it the promise of a flagship smartphone experience, but at a more affordable price. But despite packing some seriously good cameras, a fun design language and a gorgeous display, the phone did suffer a little when it came to the core hardware. Now at the turn of the year, Samsung launched the Galaxy S21 FE. It has improvements in key departments, including design and core hardware. Let's see how it fares.



BUILD AND DESIGN

The first you will notice is how the phone has obvious design similarities with the Galaxy S20 FE. There's the use of plastic at the back with the frame on both the phones created using metal.

But, there are plenty of differences as well. Because of the presence of a slightly smaller display and thinner bezels on the S21 FE, the phone looks and feels more compact in the hand. It is also a little lighter at 177 grams compared to the S20 FE weighing 190g.

The Galaxy S21 FE also has a redesigned camera module which is more in line with the one found on the other S21 series phones.

DISPLAY

At the front of the phone, we have a 6.4-inch display. This is a flat display that offers support for up to FHD+ resolution. The AMOLED panel used on the device is quite feature-rich and is capable of fast refresh rates. While there is no support for adaptive refresh rates, it does offer support for working at either 60Hz or 120Hz. The display offers deep blacks and punchy colours, making it great for watching movies or consuming multimedia content.

In our Calman display tests, the Galaxy S21 FE performed well, clocking up an average DeltaE of 2.6 in

both the sRGB and DCI-P3 colour space. However, in both the max DeltaE was a little on the higher side. Calman testing of the display also showed a very good contrast ratio and decent RGB balance as well.

PERFORMANCE

In India, the Galaxy S21 FE 5G is powered by the Exynos 2100 SoC. On the phone, this chip has been paired with 8GB of LPDDR5 memory and up to 256GB of UFS3.1 storage.

In benchmarks, this combination serves the phone well, with the S21 FE 5G racking up high scores in tests such as AnTuTu, Geekbench and 3D Mark WildLife. Interestingly, not only were these benchmarks scores higher than what the similarly specced Galaxy S21 Ultra achieved, but surprisingly also better than what some Snapdragon 888-based phones such as the OnePlus 9 managed to get in our tests.

In real-world scenarios, these numbers translated into smooth performance. Gaming performance too was good, with Gamebench showing the S21 FE can handle resource-intensive games such as Asphalt 9 Legends and Call of Duty 5 with relative ease.

CAMERA

Samsung has equipped the device with a triple rear camera setup that features a 12MP primary lens with support for OIS sat next to another 12MP ultra-wide camera. Completing the camera set-up is an 8MP telephoto lens with 3X optical zoom. All three lenses throw up some really good results, with the primary lens churning out good shots in the daytime. The lens captured detailed shots with rich and accurate colours. These shots offer good dynamic range and even more improved results with HDR on. The ultra-wide lens is also good, with clicking shots with plenty of details in them. However, there is some fish-eye effect in the images captured using this lens. The telephoto lens is our least favourite lens of the set-up.

BATTERY

For battery, the Samsung Galaxy S21 FE comes with a 4,500mAh battery. This pack manages to ensure the phone lasts over a day on moderate use and also gets you through the day even if subjected to heavy usage.

When the phone runs out of charge, the device can be topped up using a 25W charger in about an hour and a half.

VERDICT

With all the gyan out of the way, let's get to the all-important question. Is the Galaxy S21 FE worth buying? For us, the answer would be a yes. The Galaxy S21 FE is a good deal if you're looking to buy a new phone that not only works like a truly high-end device but also looks and feels as such.

—Sushant Talwar

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.40-inch FHD+ | DISPLAY TYPE: Dynamic AMOLED 2X | PROCESSOR: Exynos 2100 SoC (5nm) | FRONT CAMERA: 32MP | REAR CAMERA: 12MP + 12MP + 8MP | RAM: 8GB | STORAGE: 256GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 4500mAh | OS: One UI 4 based on Android 12

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